Reciprocals

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Reciprocals

What is a reciprocal?

- The **reciprocal** of a number is the result of **dividing 1 by that number**
  - Any number multiplied by its reciprocal will be equal to 1
- The reciprocal of 3 is $\frac{1}{3}$
  - The reciprocal of $\frac{1}{3}$ is 3
  - $3 \times \frac{1}{3} = \frac{1}{3} \times 3 = 1$
- The reciprocal of $\frac{2}{3}$ is $\frac{3}{2}$
  - The reciprocal of $\frac{3}{2}$ is $\frac{2}{3}$
  - $\frac{2}{3} \times \frac{3}{2} = \frac{3}{2} \times \frac{2}{3} = 1$
- Algebraically the reciprocal of a is $\frac{1}{a}$
  - The reciprocal of $\frac{1}{a}$ is a
  - This can also be written using a power of -1
    - $\frac{1}{a} = a^{-1}$

Help me understand

Worked Example

Write down a fraction that completes this calculation:

$$\frac{3}{7} \times \frac{\dots}{\dots} = 1$$

Answer:

Recall that a number multiplied by its reciprocal is equal to 1

$$\frac{3}{7} \times \frac{7}{3} = 1$$

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